

"This shows the savage nature of the Maoists—the brutality and savagery they are capable of."

P. CHIDAMBARAM Union Home Minister



to be fought on many fronts: military, social and economic.

■ CHANGE STRATEGY

Instead of area dominance, target and cripple the leadership

Experts say a strategic shift in the government's current Maoist policy is imperative. Instead of chasing the tail of the Maoists with its inadequate resources, the Government needs to seize the initiative. "Territorial dominance will have to be deferred. Maoist capacities must be immediately targeted," says Ajai Sahni. This move requires a complete reorientation of existing police forces, with the largest possible proportion of the state police retrained, equipped and mandated to deal with the Maoists.

The tactical emphasis, experts say, must focus immediately on intelligence-led and narrowly targeted operations seeking out the leadership, rather than dissipating forces on chasing lower rung cadres of the Maoists. A massive expansion of state

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and Central force capabilities must follow before the Maoists can be fully neutralised. The government has to address other issues like cutting off the supply of funds, arms and explosives to them.

■ GET STATES TO FALL IN LINE

For coordinated action across Naxal-affected states

Chidambaram says he is not in favour of straying from his 'carefully chosen

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